



TIPS & TRICKS



Finding files and directories

Here are two commands, which find files and directories that are not readable by all users. Such a search capability is very handy while administering Web servers. To find such files, type:

```
# find -type f ! -perm -444
```

And for finding directories that are not accessible by all users, type:

```
# find -type d ! -perm -444
```

—Shreehari Dhat,
shreeharidhat@gmail.com



Taking screenshots from the command line

The `scrot` command is used to get screenshots from the command line. This utility comes with various options that offer what almost any regular screenshot app does. This is handy when you want to take screenshots on the fly.

```
#arulmagi@curiosity-box ~/Templates $ scrot
```

The above command will grab screenshots from all the active windows in your display. If you want to select a particular part on the monitor, then use the `-s` option.

```
#arulmagi@curiosity-box ~/Templates $ scrot -s
```

After entering it in the terminal, you can use the mouse to grab a shot of a particular part of the screen from your active window.

—Magimai Prakash,
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Formatting removable media using the Linux console

Here is a command that can be used to format any removable USB drive:

```
#sudo mkfs.vfat /path/to/device
```

...where the device name is the full path to your USB device in the `/dev` directory. It is usually `/dev/sdb1`, `/dev/sdc1`, etc, and can be found by issuing an `ls` command in the `/dev` directory. Do be careful about the device name, as you can lose data if it's wrongly used.

—Vishnu N K,
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MySQL backup and restore

Here is a tip that can help you back up and restore the MySQL database. To take a full backup of the database, use the following command:

```
# mysqldump -u user -p -h hostname database_name > backup.sql
```

For importing or restoring the database, use the command given below:

```
# mysql -u user -p database_name < outputfile.sql
```



Note: To take a backup of stored procedures, use the `-R` or `--routines` flag, but this is not available in versions prior to MySQL 5.0.13.

—Rahul Ghose,
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Generate random numbers in bash

We often want to generate random numbers for various programming purposes. Like other programming languages, bash also provides a way to generate random numbers. Bash provides the 'RANDOM' environment variable. Each time this environment variable is referenced, a random integer between 0 to 32767 is generated. The examples given below will give you an idea about the RANDOM environment variable.

```
[bash]$ echo $RANDOM  
24465
```